



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*ātmajñānaṃ paro dharmāḥ sarve dharmakarmaṇām | [sarvadharmakarmaṇām?]
pradhānaṃ sarvavidvānāṃ prāpyate hy amṛtaṃ tataḥ | |18| |
tapobhir dustapais taptair vratais tais tais ca puṣkaraiḥ |
ātmajñānaṃ vinā mokṣo na bhaved yogīnām api | |20| |*

— Yogapradīpa, Chapter 1, Verses 18-20

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The supreme duty, the Yogapradīpa tells us, is the realization of the Self. This isn't just another good deed or ritual; it's the very essence of all righteous actions, the pinnacle of wisdom for those who seek knowledge. Why? Because it is through this self-knowledge that we attain immortality, that state beyond suffering and limitation. All the rituals, all the religious actions, all the austerities are subordinate to this one goal. They are valuable only insofar as they propel us towards the understanding of who we truly are.

Think about it: how often do you get caught up in doing what you *think* you should be doing, following prescribed paths laid out by society or tradition? We perform our duties, we adhere to our roles, but are we truly present, truly aware of the motivations behind our actions? The Yogapradīpa suggests that without the foundation of self-knowledge, even the most rigorous spiritual practices are ultimately incomplete. We might be ticking all the boxes, but missing the point entirely.

Even yogis, deeply immersed in their practices, cannot achieve liberation without this vital self-awareness. It underscores that yoga, in its truest form, isn't just about physical postures or breathing techniques. These are tools, powerful tools indeed, but their purpose is to turn your gaze inward, to peel back the layers of conditioning and illusion that obscure your true Self.

In our modern world, filled with distractions and external pressures, this message is more relevant than ever. We are bombarded with messages telling us who to be, what to buy, and how to live. But the Yogapradīpa invites you to disconnect from the noise, to cultivate inner stillness, and to ask yourself the fundamental question: "Who am I, beyond all these external definitions?" It is in that quiet contemplation, in that deep exploration of your inner landscape, that you will discover the path to true and lasting fulfillment.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

If all your actions stem from a place of seeking to know yourself, how might that change your daily life and interactions with others?